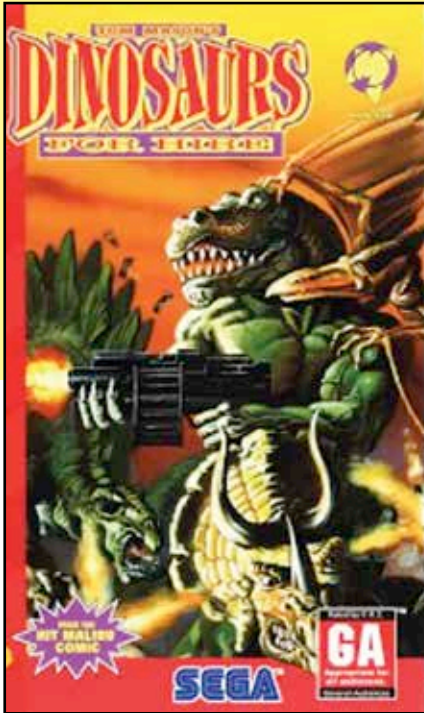




TOOTH AND CLAW

A brief history of dinosaurs in video games

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How me someone who isn't a fan of dinosaurs and I'll show you a person without a soul. We've been enthralled since man first discovered the existence of these magnificent beasts. Whether it's the T-Rex's awe-inspiring visage or the Velociraptor's vicious hunting tactics, dinosaurs have captured the imagination of storytellers for centuries. We've had numerous novels, films and shows that featured dinosaurs and video games are no different. Right from the inception of the industry, dinosaurs have been staples as companions, bosses and enemies in hundreds of games across all platforms. The most famous of these is the Dino Crisis series, published by Capcom and directed by horror maestro Shinji Mikami. But, apart from just acting as antagonists in video games, dinosaurs have also been sad-

dled as loyal companions (Yoshi, anyone?), mounts and more. The length and breadth of dinosaurs in games are vast and we're going to try and condense the entire history of these prehistoric monsters in video games.

Roaring into the 8 and 16-Bit era

Even though we've had games like Dino Wars for the Commodore 64 and Atari 2600, the first real recognizable dinos in games were the enemies in Dino Riki on the NES. Sure, looking back at the graphics, they weren't great but you could clearly see that the developers put in the work when it came to the dinosaurs in the game.

Heck, even the main character had fewer sprite animations compared to the dino enemies. But it was Super Mario World for the SNES that gave us the most loved and rec-

ognizable dino in gaming, Yoshi! Released for the Super Nintendo in 1988, Super Mario World was not only an incredible game, but it also introduced dinosaur mounts. You could essentially ride Yoshi on various levels, using his fire breath as an attack. Again, Yoshi isn't the most realistic dinosaur in gaming, but he's definitely the most memorable.

The next big dino game in the 16-bit era was Dinosaurs for Hire for the Sega Genesis. The game was a

